Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 6 4 ♥ A 7 3 ♦ K Q 5 4 ♣ A K 8 2	
♠ A 10 2 ♥ 10 8 4 ♦ J 10 9 3 ♣ Q 10 5	N W E S	♠ K 5 ♥ J 9 5 2 ♦ A 8 6 ♣ 9 7 6 3
	♠ Q J 9 8 7 3 ♥ K Q 6 ♦ 7 2 ♣ J 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South

HE WHO KNOWS, GOES You **KNOW** your side has 26-28 points. You **KNOW** your side has 8 or more ♠s. You **GO** to 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦J.

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Losers: ♠ 2/3 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3/4

You are definitely going to lose the ♦A and the ♠ A K. Therefore you must plan to avoid losing a third ♠.

You should lead **UP TO** your honor cards. Cover the ♦J and lose to East's ♦A. Win his return (probably another ♦) in dummy. Lead a small ♠ to your ♠J. West wins with an honor and probably plays the ♦10. Ruff it, lead a ♣ to dummy and lead the last ♠. If East plays the other high honor you play low. If East plays low you guess whether to play the ♠K, or ♠10. Your best play is to assume the two honors were split and play the ♠Q.

Leading twice toward the ♠ Q J gives you a guarantee on this layout because East held a doubleton high honor.

Now

Here West has taken your ♠J with the ♠A. When you again lead a small ♠ from dummy say that East plays the ♠5.

You might think that West is just as likely to have held an original doubleton ♠ A K as doubleton ♠ A 10, and that playing the ♠9 would be as good a play as ♠Q.

This is untrue for a very classy-named reason - **The Principle of Restricted Choice**. You may not even believe it when you read it, but it's mathematically sound. If West were dealt an original ♠ A K, he would have been just as likely to win with the ♠K as with the ♠A. The fact that he actually won the ♠A makes it less likely that he also holds the ♠K.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	North	
	♠ A J 5 2	
	♥ 8 5 4	
	♦ A K J 3	
	♣ 8 4	
West	N / W E / S	**East**
♠ K 9		♠ 10 7 4
♥ K Q 10 6		♥ A J 3
♦ 9 6 4		♦ 10 8 5 2
♣ 10 7 5 2		♣ J 9 3
	South	
	♠ Q 8 6 3	
	♥ 9 7 2	
	♦ Q 7	
	♣ A K Q 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South

A jump to 2NT would not be a terrible bid. But it is more important to show your 4-card Major.

So you bid 1♠ instead. Partner raises to 2♠.

It's another case of **HE WHO KNOWS, GOES**. You know you have at least 26 points and 8 ♠s. Of course you trust that partner would not raise a suit you bid as responder with only 3 trumps. So you bid 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥K. The defense takes the first three ♥ tricks, then switch to a ♣.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥K. The defense takes the first three ♥ tricks, then switch to a ♣.

Losers: ♠ ? : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3?

It kinda makes you wish you'd bid 2NT after all doesn't it?

At least the picture is clear. Very clear. You have no wiggle room left so you must bring in the ♠s without losing a trick. So West **MUST** have the ♠K. Therefore you assume West does hold the ♠K.

Suppose you lead the ♠Q. West will play his ♠K and force you to play dummy's ♠A. Then one of the defenders will win the third ♠ with the ♠10 or ♠9.

No, you only have one chance to make this contract - West must hold a doubleton ♠ K x. So you lead a **SMALL** ♠ from your hand and finesse dummy's ♠J. Then play the ♠A, dropping West's ♠K, then pull the last trump with the ♠Q.

The reason you must not lead the ♠Q is that West will always cover and that will force you to use two of your honors on one trick.

Since you would only have one more honor you'd be bound to lose a trick.

Board 5 South Deals None Vul	♠ A 7 2 ♥ Q J 3 ♦ Q 8 6 2 ♣ 9 6 4	
♠ Q J 10 9 8 4 ♥ A 5 ♦ 9 3 ♣ Q J 10	N W E S	♠ 5 3 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2 ♦ A 7 5 ♣ 7 5 3
	♠ K 6 ♥ K 9 8 ♦ K J 10 4 ♣ A K 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
2♠	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South